COACHE

Collaborative on Academic Careers in Higher Education

Priority Setting Taskforce Report

FGCU | Academic Affairs

December 2023

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Executive Summary

The Collaborative on Academic Careers in Higher Education (COACHE) was designed by Harvard and collaborating institutions to study the postsecondary faculty experience. Florida Gulf Coast University (FGCU) partnered with COACHE for the first time this year for the purpose of assessing faculty satisfaction with their work experiences so that informed change could be implemented where needed. This was one of many steps that the Office of the Provost is taking to make FGCU a positive and productive work environment for retaining current and attracting future high-quality faculty.

A high percentage (66%) of eligible, full-time faculty completed the survey in Spring 2023. The survey was comprised of over 200 questions and an open-ended question, covering 25 benchmarks and nine thematic breakouts, all of which aligned with faculty workplace experiences common to the higher education institutions that partner with the COACHE project. The Office of the Provost and the FGCU Faculty Senate campaigned vigorously to encourage all eligible full-time faculty to complete the survey so that the results would be representative of faculty work experiences across the campus.

COACHE then generated reports, tables, and graphics in which FGCU faculty survey data were compared to two groups, peer and cohort higher education institutions. FGCU's Priority-Setting Taskforce then analyzed the comparisons and identified institutional strengths and concerns. These strengths and concerns were frequently and extensively discussed among members of the CPST for the purpose of identifying two actionable concerns, per Provost Rieger's charge to the taskforce. This report includes an overview of all the major strengths and concerns, but then narrows its focus on a primary strength and two prioritized concerns. Both the strength and the two concerns represent an aggregate of relevant data from across the 25 benchmarks and nine thematic breakouts.

The two areas of concern are well documented with evidence from the survey, which the next group of faculty, the COACHE Strategy-Setting Taskforce, can use to recommend potential courses of action to the provost. The primary strength was mentoring, which included collegial and supportive peer relationships. The two prioritized concerns were the culture of leadership and resources and support. The primary strength and two concerns are presented in the Key Findings text box.

It is expected that FGCU will continue its partnership with COACHE as one form of continuous formative assessment and improvement. A second iteration of the survey is planned for spring 2026, the results of which will be used as a measurement of change in faculty satisfaction with their work experiences and as the basis for another round of identifying institutional strengths and concerns to inform further change.

CPST Key Findings

- Mentorship
- Culture of Leadership
- Resources and Support

COACHE Priority-Setting Taskforce Report

Introduction

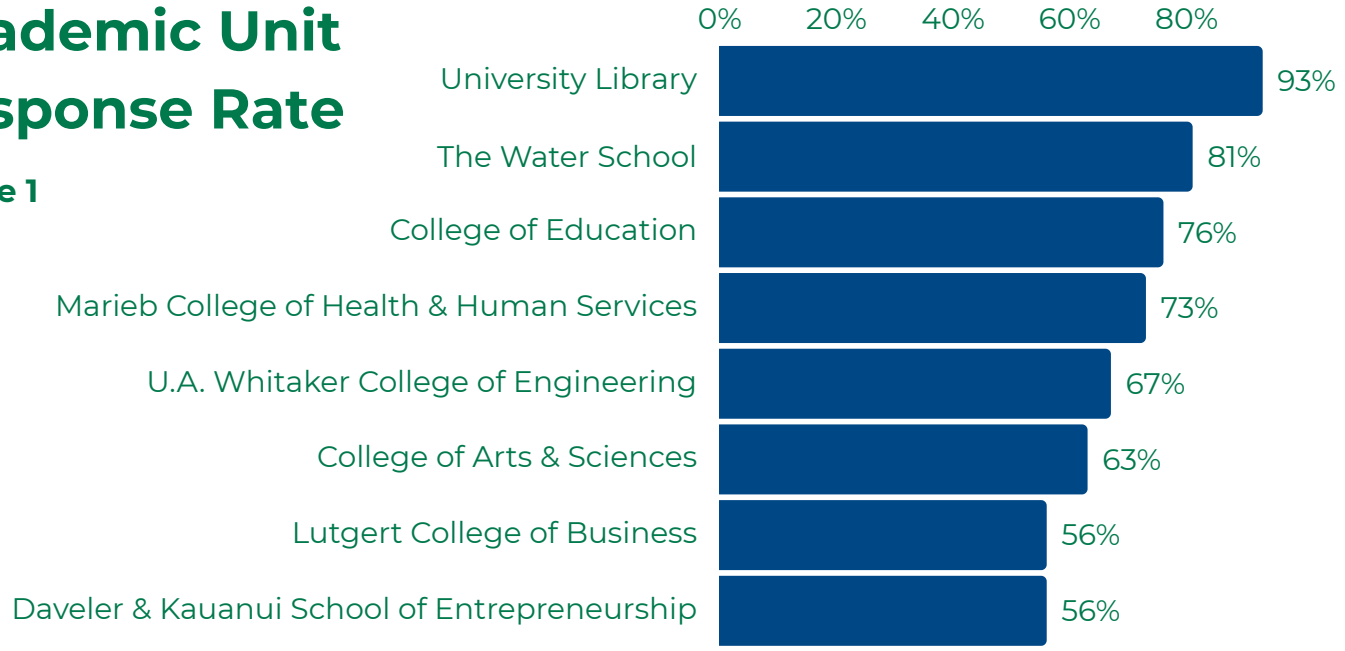
The Collaborative on Academic Careers in Higher Education (COACHE) is a research-practice partnership between over 300 leaders of higher education institutions and the Harvard Graduate School of Education, a partnership devoted to studying the postsecondary faculty experience. The function of the partnership is to collect information on a wide range of critical issues related to faculty satisfaction and engagement in the workplace. To that end, Florida Gulf Coast University (FGCU) partnered with COACHE to determine the drivers of faculty success and to implement informed change.

The COACHE faculty job satisfaction survey was administered for the first time at FGCU in Spring 2023. Office of the Provost and FGCU Faculty Senate formed a steering committee that administered the survey for the purpose of benchmarking faculty satisfaction across nine areas of faculty workplace experiences. The results will serve as a baseline for measuring change in future administrations of the survey.

The survey was administered to all full-time faculty employed as of November 1, 2022, excluding advisors, assistant deans, associate deans, and deans. FGCU had a high faculty response rate; 362 of 549 eligible faculty (66%) completed the anonymous survey. FGCU's faculty response rate was higher than that of its peer institutions (43%) and of the COACHE cohort institutions (42%). The response rates across FGCU academic units, all of which were over 55%, are represented in Figure 1.

Academic Unit Response Rate

Figure 1



Introduction

Following the close of the survey, COACHE provided FGCU with a hard copy summary of their findings, referred to as a preview report, and the COACHE Chief Academic Officer Report, otherwise known as the dashboard. These reports contained item-level analyses, faculty comments to open-ended questions coded by survey theme, results disaggregated by school/college and discipline and participant demographics, and more tools for understanding the work conditions faculty need to be successful. In addition, this report provided internal and external comparisons of actionable results in an easy-to-navigate format. The data were compared to peer and cohort institutions. The list of peer institutions follows in Figure 2.

Peer Institutions

The FGCU Faculty Senate, in collaboration with Academic Affairs, selected five peer institutions with which FGCU's COACHE survey results were compared. While no Florida universities are truly FGCU peer institutions, the Faculty Senate thought it important to include one Florida institution.

- Appalachian State University (2022)
- Bowling Green State University (2023)
- Florida International University (2020)
- University of Tennessee at Chattanooga (2022)
- Wichita State University (2020)

Figure 2

Cohort Institutions

86

Faculty from 86 institutions were in the comparison cohort of universities for this 2023 report. They comprise all higher education institutions that have been active partners with the COACHE project for the past three years. The data are able to be compared to 'Peers" (our five selected institutions) or "cohort" (all institutions in the database). The list of institutions can be viewed in the COACHE Preview Report.

Taskforce Commitment

Academic Affairs convened the COACHE Priority-Setting Taskforce (CPST) in August 2023 and charged it with analyzing data from the 2023 COACHE survey results. The taskforce members who volunteered were intentionally selected to represent colleges, schools, and the library to provide a complete, accurate, balanced, and transparent reporting of survey results.

Through an iterative process, the CPST analyzed the survey data and clustered commonalities that emerged from across the 25 benchmarks for further exploration and discussion of faculty satisfaction with their workplace experiences. The findings and conclusions are delineated in this report, and will be shared broadly with faculty, leadership, and administrators for discussion and feedback.

Benchmark Scores and Survey Themes

The COACHE Survey has over 200 questions, most of which are five-point Likert scale items and one open-ended question, and categorized into 25 benchmarks and nine thematic breakouts. The survey's comparative framework serves as a foundation for establishing benchmarks and thematic breakouts for comparison to future survey findings. The survey is designed to get in-depth feedback from faculty on a breadth of issues related to their job satisfaction. Complex adaptive branching is embedded in the survey to ensure that participants only answer questions related to their background and experience. Each survey theme is summarized by a "Benchmark," which is the mean of responses from survey questions that share a common theme. The following 25 benchmarked themes are addressed in the survey:

COACHE Thematic Breakouts & Benchmarks

- Nature of Work:
  - Research
  - Service
  - Teaching
- Resources and Support
  - Facilities and Work Resources
  - Personal and Family Policies
  - Health and Retirement Benefits
- Cross-Silo work and mentorship
  - Interdisciplinary Work
  - Collaboration
  - Mentoring
- Tenure and Promotion
  - Tenure Policies
  - Tenure Expectations: Clarity
  - Promotion to Full
- Institutional Leadership
  - Leadership: Senior
  - Leadership: Divisional (School/College)
  - Leadership: Departmental
  - Leadership: Faculty
- Shared Governance
  - Governance: Trust
  - Governance: Shared Sense of Purpose
  - Governance: Understanding the Issue at Hand
  - Governance: Adaptability
  - Governance: Productivity
- The Department
  - Departmental Collegiality
  - Departmental Engagement
  - Departmental Quality
- Appreciation and Recognition
- Retention and Negotiation

Introduction

Strengths and Concerns Based on Benchmark Scores

The distinguishing feature of the COACHE dataset lies in its capacity to facilitate analysis through the comparative examination of FGCU's responses to those of designated peer institutions, as well as to a cohort of 86 institutions that actively engaged in the partnership with COACHE in the preceding three years. This comparative framework serves as a foundation for furnishing evaluative insights on strengths and concerns. In short, COACHE operationalizes an "area of strength" as any benchmark where FGCU attains a ranking of first or second compared to our peers and positions itself within the top 30% of the cohort. Conversely, an "area of concern" manifests when the FGCU rating for a benchmark ranks fifth or sixth among its peers and falls in the lower 30% of the cohort. The survey themes below met these criteria for FGCU.

Areas of Strength

Mentoring

Areas of Concern

Collaboration
Departmental Quality
Governance: Adaptability
Governance: Shared Sense of Purpose
Governance: Trust
Nature of Work: Research
Nature of Work: Teaching
Personal and Family Policies

Best and Worst Aspects of Working at FGCU

COACHE also asked faculty to consider the bigger picture at the institution. Faculty were asked to identify two best and two worst aspects of their work experience at the university. The four most frequently cited responses in each category are listed below.

Best Aspects:	Quality of colleagues, 33% Geographic location, 33% Support of colleagues, 27% Quality of undergraduate students, 13%
Worst Aspects:	Compensation, 42% Cost of living, 23% Quality of leadership, 18% Lack of support for research/creative work, 16%

Introduction

Global Considerations: In Your Faculty's Own Words

The COACHE survey provided faculty the opportunity to answer an open-text response to the prompt, "What is the one thing your institution could do to improve the workplace for faculty?" The comments from faculty were reviewed by COACHE, redacted of identifying information and coded according to the survey themes. The five most common themes are detailed in Figure 3. Compensation and benefits were addressed in 43% of the comments. Senior leadership was a referenced theme in the top five, at 13%.

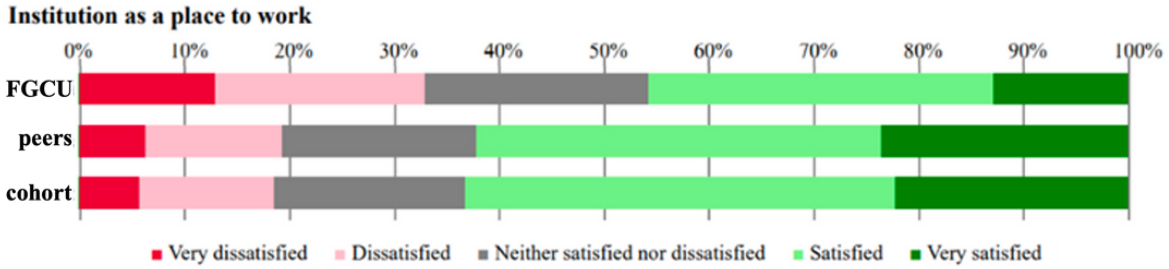
What is the one thing your institution could do to improve the workplace for faculty?

Top 5 Most Common Themes Identified for Improvement

Compensation and benefits - 43%
Culture - 21%
Leadership: General - 14%
Nature of work: General - 14%
Leadership: Senior - 13%

Figure 3

COACHE looked at other "big picture" results concerning overall satisfaction, intent to leave, and the likelihood that a faculty member would recommend her/his department as a place to work. As a result, they shared respondents' overall satisfaction with FCGU as a place to work, as reflected below.



Note: This figure was produced by COACHE, summarizing the Global Considerations in the Chief Academic Officer Report 2023

Figure 3

Work Group Process

The COACHE Priority-Setting Taskforce (CPST) members have been meeting since August 2023 to analyze COACHE survey data and prepare a report for the provost that can also be shared university-wide. The charge from Provost Rieger was to identify at least two thematic concerns from the survey results that can be acted upon to improve FGCU faculty satisfaction with their work experiences.

However, the COACHE data transcended these two thematic areas, and the CPST believed that it is important for the university community to receive a full and transparent accounting of the results. Therefore, while this report's scope does not allow for a full discussion of all the data, the CPST plans to share the broader findings at a series of town hall meetings and to make available the complete results.

To examine the data beyond the summary report provided by COACHE, the 12 CPST faculty members were paired into six teams, and each team volunteered to parse that data attached to one or more of the nine thematic breakout areas for a deeper analysis. These thematic breakout areas were (a) Nature of Work (divided into teaching, research, and service), (b) Resources and Support, (c) Cross-Silo Work and Mentorship, (d) Tenure and Promotion, (e) Institutional Leadership, (f) Shared Governance, (g) The Department, (h) Appreciation and Recognition, and (i) Retention and Negotiation. CPST co-chairs created a "workbook template" that included space for each faculty pair to record findings about the themes they analyzed. The primary objectives were to identify areas of strength and areas of concern and to document the evidence on which these conclusions were based.

Thematic findings were summarized and shared among all CPST members. The members met bi-weekly to identify themes common to multiple areas of faculty work experience and determine which two areas of concern were most prominent. The two most common areas of concern were Theme 1: Culture of Leadership and Theme 2: Resources and Support. These two priority areas were the result of specific findings from across all COACHE benchmarks and thematic breakouts.

By engaging in the rigorous process described here, the CPST is confident that the findings and the interpretations of those findings are grounded in the COACHE data, primarily the comparative quantitative data that show the satisfaction of our faculty in relation to our peer and cohort institutions, but also reflect faculty responses to an open-ended survey question. Together, the quantitative and qualitative data revealed important insights regarding the perceptions of faculty in these two thematic areas.

These two themes are not worded specifically with the thematic language that COACHE uses but rather represent the whole of the findings from all nine thematic breakout areas. Conversely, not all the specified areas of concern on p. 7 of this report contributed to the two themes when the priorities were set. Decisions were based on the collective findings about what was most important to the faculty in only two areas. What follows are explanations of each of the two themes and descriptions of the evidence from COACHE that supports their primacy.

CPST Key Findings

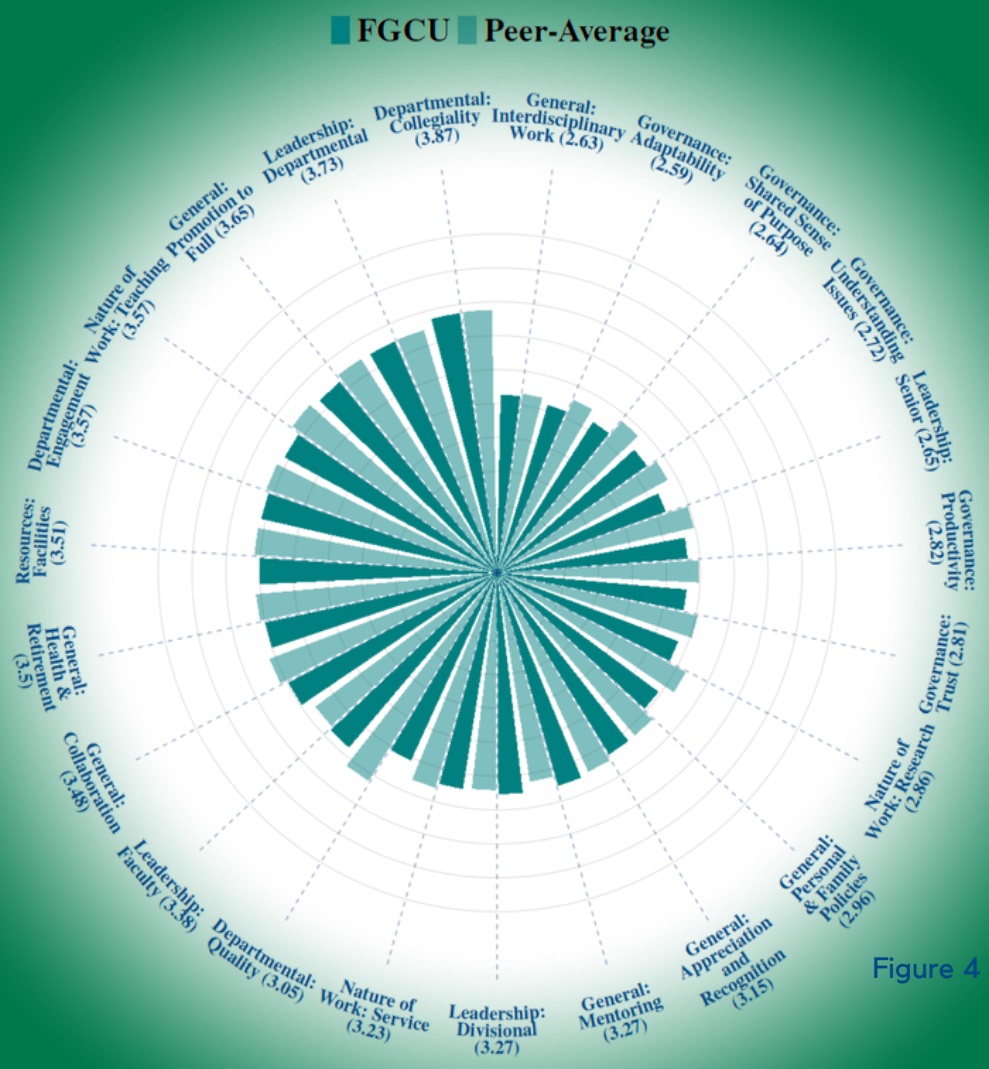


Figure 4

The CPST was cognizant of its charge to identify areas of faculty work experiences that could be improved upon. However, the taskforce took care to identify what aspects of the work experience faculty perceived as positive, as well. This section on key findings begins with what survey participants identified as a strength, followed by two themes that represented areas that were tagged as primary concerns.

Theme 1:
Culture of Leadership

Theme 2:
Resources and Support

CPST Key Findings

What We Do Well: Mentoring

Effective mentoring, both within and outside the department, was perceived by faculty as an institutional strength. Evidence showed the best aspects of working at FGCU included the quality and support of colleagues across all ranks, demographics, and disciplines. Collegiality and supportive professional relationships had positive impacts on faculty satisfaction.

Faculty Concerns

Theme 1: Culture of Leadership

A primary area of concern from faculty across the campus was labeled the culture of leadership. The culture of leadership at the university is represented by the customs, norms, and processes used to set and execute direction at FGCU. This includes who is involved in the decision-making processes and when, the expectations for involvement, listening to and hearing from the stakeholders, mutual respect and transparency, and conditions established through policies, rewards, and institutional branding that support an environment where employees thrive, all of which further the shared mission and vision of FGCU. Other processes include communication of priorities once support is gathered, clarity of direction and operations, and a pace of change that incorporates necessary input from all who are affected by the change. Individual survey items in all these areas make up the benchmarks in the four leadership categories (senior, divisional, departmental, and faculty), as well as benchmarks related to shared governance, personal and family policies, and appreciation and recognition.

CPST Key Findings

Theme 1: Culture of Leadership

Of the 25 benchmarks present in the COACHE survey data, four benchmarks were comprised of 20 items that directly measured faculty satisfaction with institutional leadership in the following categories: senior, divisional, departmental, and faculty. However, leadership aspects were also represented by survey items related to benchmarks for governance and institutional policies. For example, in the "Shared Governance" thematic breakout area, several items assessed faculty perceptions regarding trust in administrators and shared sense of purpose; responses to these questions also conveyed attitudes about leadership at the university. In addition, in the "Appreciation and Recognition" thematic breakout area, the extent to which faculty receive recognition from and feel valued by university leaders such as chairs, deans, provosts, and presidents was probed. Thus, in identifying the broad theme of "culture of leadership," the CPST drew from several benchmarks that it believed enable us it provide a comprehensive accounting of the faculty perspective on the leadership culture of the FGCU.

There are several COACHE data points that illustrate faculty respondents' concerns with the culture of leadership at FGCU. For example, when given a list of 26 items and asked to select only two of the "worst aspects about working at your institution," 18% of faculty selected "Quality of Leadership." The only items on the list that received a higher percentage of responses were "Compensation" (42%) and "Cost of living" (23%). In addition, of the four COACHE benchmarks that directly reference leadership (senior, divisional, departmental, faculty) the mean score was lowest for "Leadership: Senior" (2.65) which placed us fourth lowest out of the six universities in peer group and in the 13th percentile in the cohort.

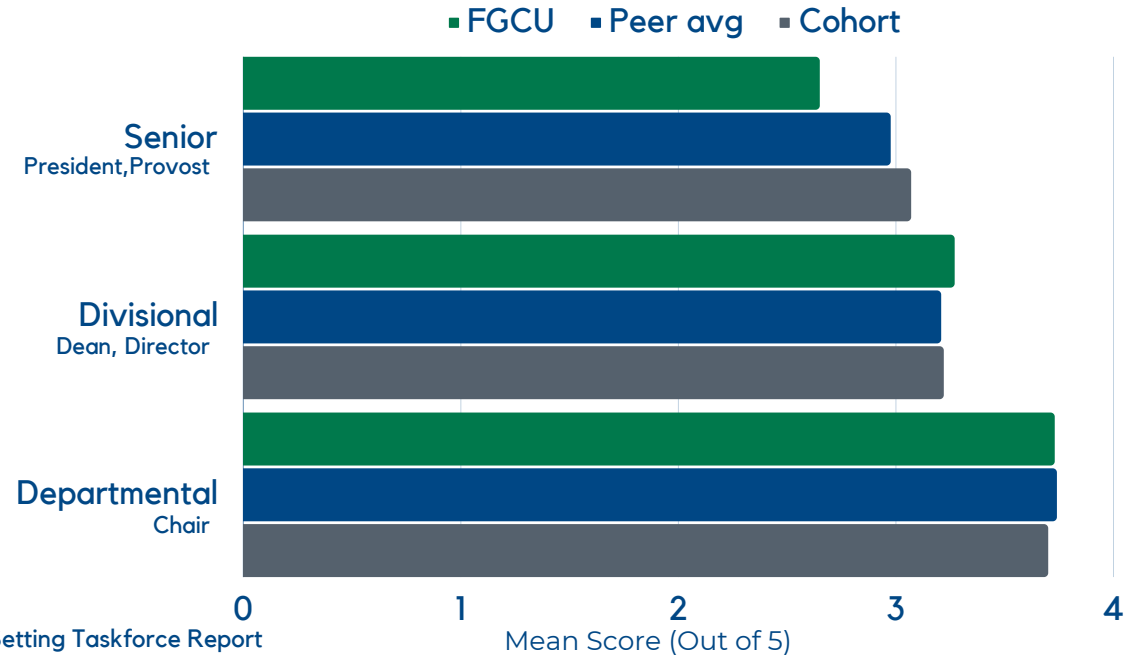


Figure 5

CPST Key Findings

Theme 1: Culture of Leadership

CPST also drew inferences about the culture of leadership from faculty responses to benchmarks related to "Governance," particularly in the areas of "Trust" (mean=2.81) and "Shared Sense of Purpose" (mean=2.64). For each of these benchmarks, FGCU ranked fifth out of its peer group and in the 19th and 9th percentile in the cohort, respectively. Low mean values on items that comprise these benchmarks suggest that faculty were dissatisfied with administrative leadership in areas such as open communication, respect for the faculty view, and shared sense of responsibility.

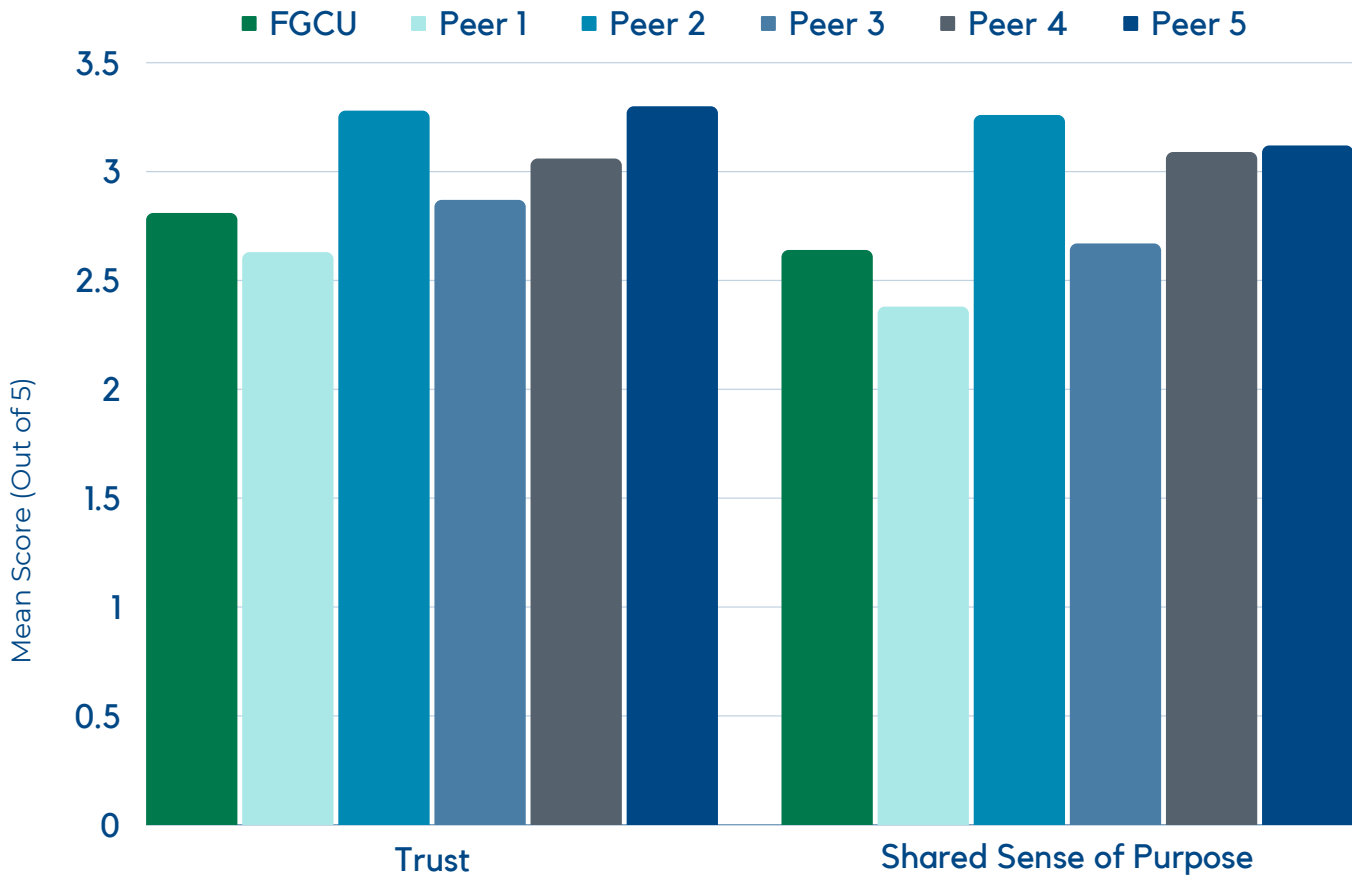


Figure 6

CPST Key Findings

Theme 1: Culture of Leadership

In addition to the quantitative COACHE data, qualitative comments made by faculty provided some context and nuance to aid in the interpretation of the numeric data. For example, the following direct quotes from the narrative responses made by faculty reflected perceptions of the culture of leadership. (It is important to note here that CPST is not drawing general conclusions from these comments alone. However, based on a thorough review of all faculty responses, CPST selected comments for illustrative purposes that it believed provide context and nuance to the quantitative results presented to this point.)

- Understand what really goes on in my school. There is a perception problem. A tremendous amount of decent work is being done in the classroom and at the individual student level. But the focus is on numbers instead of individual student and faculty success. Admin needs to spend time with faculty to understand what we do best and what needs improvement. The feedback loop is missing. Surveys only do so much.
- I wish they would read my end of the semester evaluations on SPOI (Student Perception of Instruction) and consider class placements based on them. No one reads them or follows up. Teaching and student learning are not a top priority.
- If quality teaching were rewarded, or heck, even appreciated, that would help immensely. But I see no evidence that the Administration is going for a quality education, only a push-them-through attitude, scared by student complaints about difficulty or anything else.
- Embrace our mission as a teaching institution that is primarily caring for undergraduate students who need greater levels of support than at many other institutions. The current drive to become a Research 2 institution is causing faculty to have less time to devote to struggling undergraduate students, hence our elevated level of DFW grades in key areas.
- Senior leadership is authoritarian, self-destructive, and adversarial. Decision-making is often unilateral, untenable, and presumptuous. Problem solving is complicated by frequent gaslighting, strawman arguments, and the ad hominem attacks. Truth and accuracy seem less important to leadership than the desire for control, power, and dominance. In short, leadership fosters a toxic workplace.

In each of these comments, faculty expressed dissatisfaction with aspects of administrative leadership, some of which can be distilled into the category of inadequate communication and others which seem to imply a disconnect between administrative and faculty priorities.

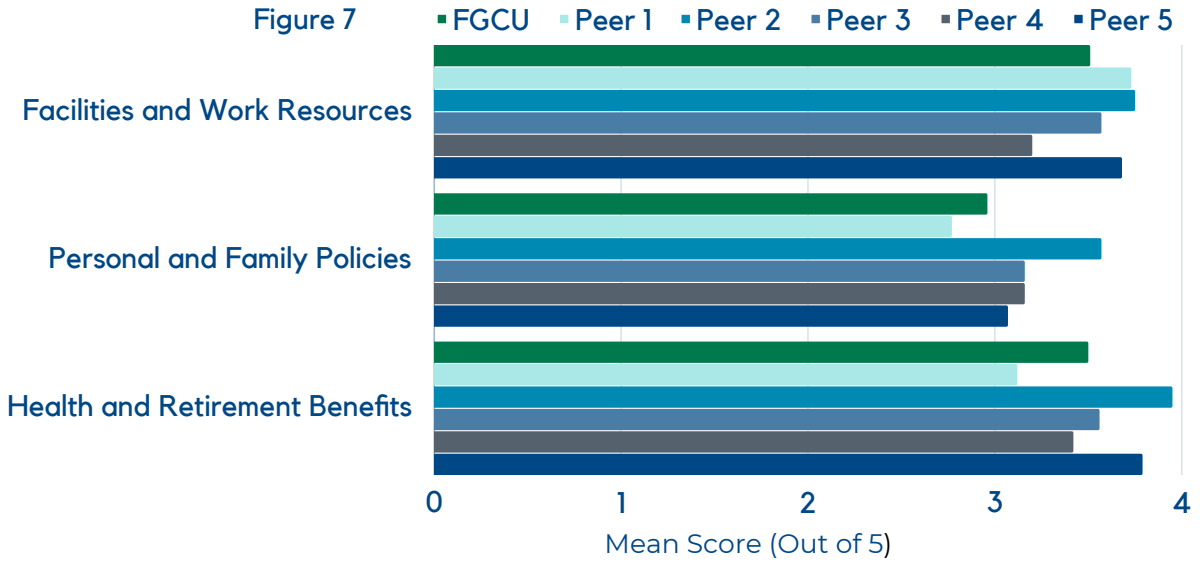
Overall, faculty are least satisfied with senior leadership, but their satisfaction with leadership increases as the position of the leaders becomes more directly relevant to the work of faculty (i.e., satisfaction with divisional leadership is higher than senior leadership, and satisfaction with departmental leadership is higher than divisional/college leadership). The items that comprise these categories are related to communication, decision-making, priority-setting, and ensuring faculty input, all of which can potentially be impacted by actions that are within the control of institutional leaders, with a goal of increasing future faculty satisfaction.

Theme 2: Resources and Support

"Resources and Support" is one of the nine COACHE thematic breakouts, and within this theme are four sub-categories: facilities and work resources, personal and family policies, health and retirement benefits, and salary. Through its analysis, the CPST learned that these areas alone do not fully capture faculty satisfaction with support in areas like teaching and professional advancement or with resources such as research infrastructure and internal funding. By defining "resources and support" more broadly than the COACHE category, the CPST was able to draw findings and conclusions from several of the thematic breakouts, including the Resources and Support theme as defined by COACHE. The other thematic areas from which the findings and conclusion were drawn were the Nature of Work, Cross-Silo Work and Mentorship, and Shared Governance. Thus, CPST identified its second thematic area to be the extent to which faculty are satisfied with the institutional support they receive to fulfill their professional responsibilities successfully. This included the extent to which faculty feel appreciated and valued, with a specific emphasis on the material and financial resources that make this success more likely.

Of the sub-categories that comprise the COACHE-defined Resources and Support thematic breakout, results indicated that FGCU ranked (a) fifth among its peers and was in the 44th percentile in the cohort for "facilities and work resources" (mean=3.51), (b) fifth among its peers and is in the 19th percentile in the cohort for "personal and family policies" (mean=2.96), and (c) fourth among its peers and 30th percentile in the cohort for "health and retirement benefits" (mean=3.50). (The fourth category, "salary," was placed outside the purview of this report.)

Figure 7



Theme 2: Resources and Support

Given that the definition of "resources and support" established by the CPST also encompasses ideas that are captured in other thematic breakouts, it is relevant to note that in the "Nature of Work" thematic breakout, FGCU ranked sixth among its peer institutions and in the 12th percentile in the cohort for "Nature of Work: Research" (mean=2.86). FGCU ranked sixth among its peers and in the 9th percentile in the cohort for "Nature of Work: Teaching" (mean=3.57), both of which contain items assessing the extent to which faculty felt supported in the fulfillment of responsibilities related to teaching and scholarship. Furthermore, FGCU ranked fourth among its peers and in the 33rd percentile in the cohort for "Appreciation and Recognition" (mean=3.15). Items in this section shed light on the extent to which faculty felt appreciated by colleagues and administrators for aspects of their work.

Specific aspects of the theme "Resources and Support" raise concerns and present opportunities for substantive interventions that could influence faculty satisfaction. For instance, one of the key takeaways is that faculty members have experienced major tension between expectations for their teaching and expectations for their research activities. These tensions are related to the equitable distribution of resources and to the support faculty experienced, with time and funding as common factors in both. This is evident in the mean scores for individual survey items and in the comparisons with peer and cohort institutions. For example, the FGCU faculty ranked sixth (last place) among its peer institutions on the "support for research," "support for obtaining grants," and "availability of course release for research" items (13th, 10th, and 2nd percentile, respectively, within the cohort). In addition, FGCU ranked sixth among peers and were in the 19th percentile of the cohort for "number of courses taught," indicating that faculty do not perceive adequate support in the form of personnel or resources allocated to departments for additional faculty.

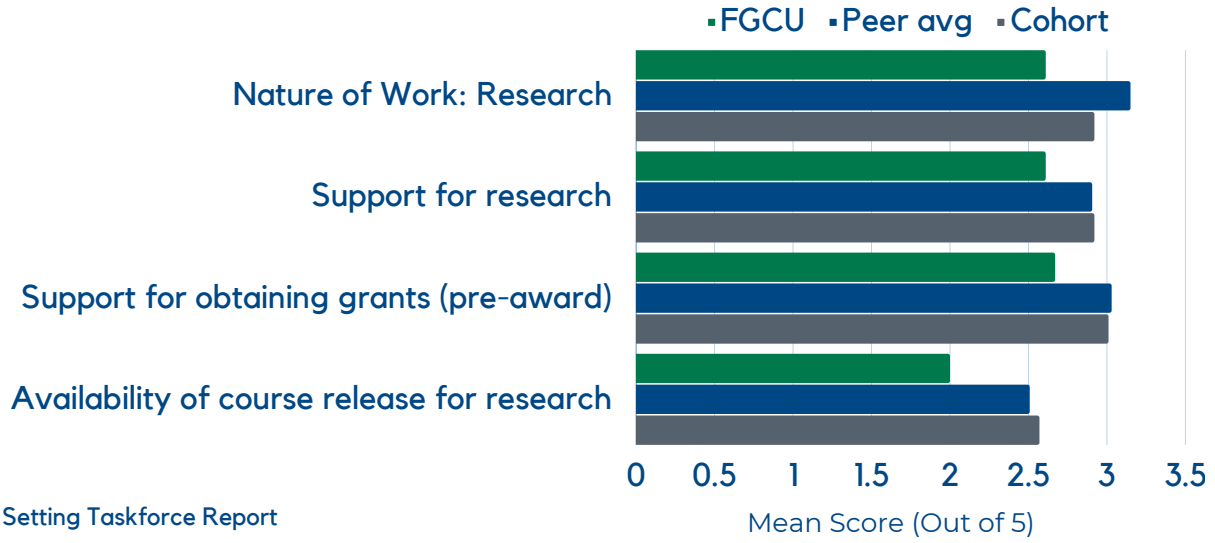
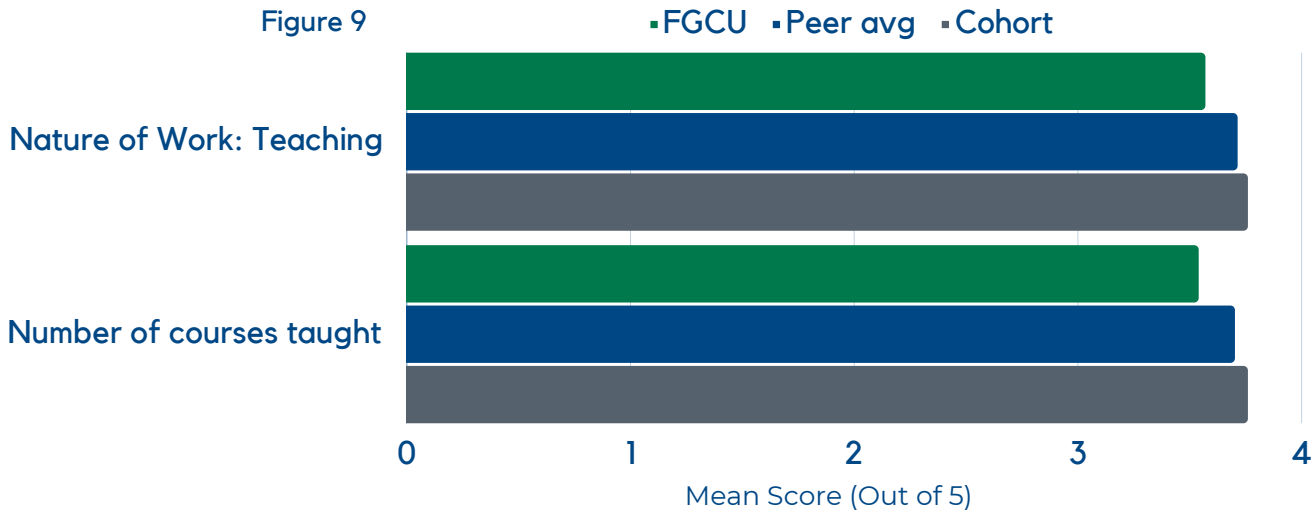


Figure 8

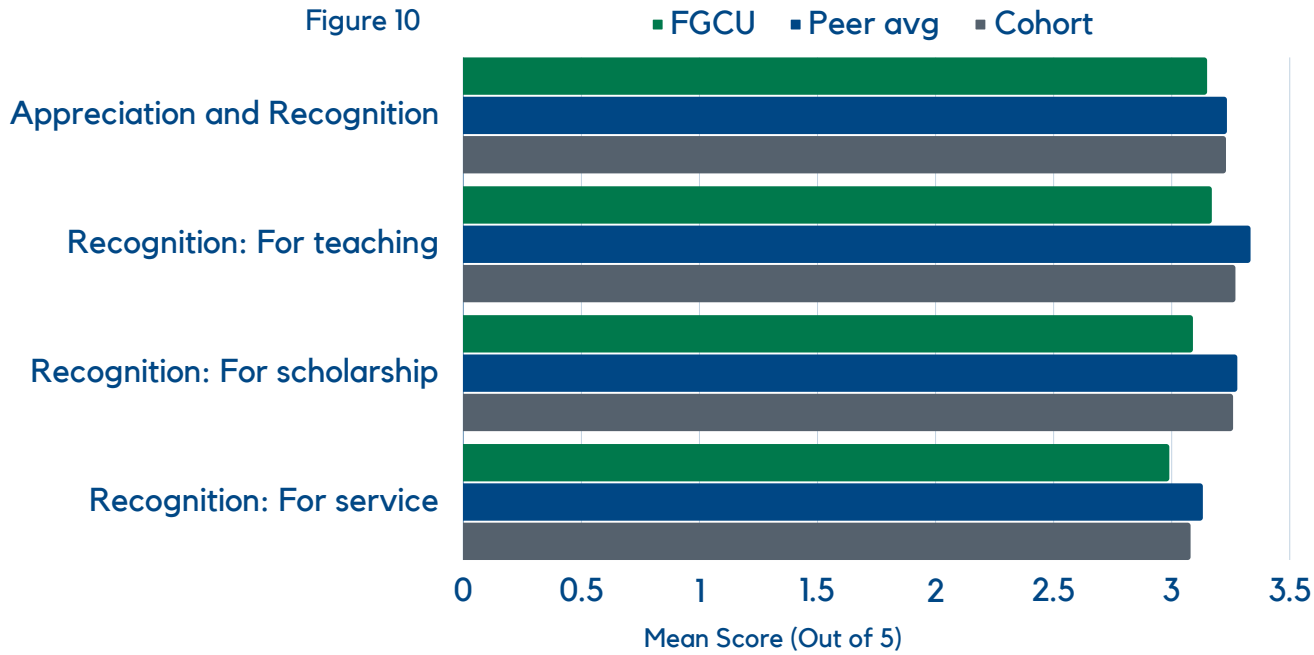
Theme 2: Resources and Support

Figure 9



To the extent that "support" is related to faculty feeling valued and appreciated, the thematic breakout area "Appreciation and Recognition" also surfaced some concerns. For example, FGCU faculty satisfaction ranked sixth among its peers on "Recognition: For scholarship" (10th percentile among the cohort) and ranked fifth for "Recognition: For teaching" and "Recognition: For service" (22nd and 26th percentiles, respectively). In addition, on items assessing the extent to which faculty believe their Academic Unit and their department are valued by the university and president, our faculty ranked fourth in comparison to the peer institutions and was in the 34th and 33rd percentile when compared to cohort institutions, respectively.

Figure 10



Theme 2: Resources and Support

Several qualitative comments made by faculty reinforced the data highlighted in this section and provided context for understanding faculty concerns related to resources, support, and appreciation. (All selected statements below are quoted directly from COACHE survey results.)

- The institution is pushing for more research; however, there are no available resources that help toward this goal. Our teaching load is high and most of the time I find myself taking an overload to keep up with the financial demands... If the institution wants productivity on the research level, they need to provide the needed infrastructure for it, as well as the financial support to engage in interdisciplinary projects.
- It's never one thing! So' here are a few pertinent issues: Adequate faculty funding for research and research support; develop more graduate programs and support research more rigorously; reduce teaching load, equate time for more research.
- Beyond increased compensation, more support (both time and money) for research and creative projects. For example, course releases for research/creative activities; adjusting contracted course loads for those who teach upper-division courses (because course load is not just the number of classes but also the number of preparations each semester, which varies by program and level); increase in departmental funding for research travel and making the process for compensation less onerous, etc.
- The institution has prided itself on being a teaching and service institution since its inception; yet we are constantly asked to produce more research with no additional financial support, course releases, or any other way to support this required increased productivity. Our work/life balance is increasingly untenable.
- More course release for program coordinators. Currently just one course release is granted per academic year (with no salary compensation, either), which forces us to work with zero workload compensation for half of the year (so the program management tasks are simply added to regular teaching and other duties).
- Reallocate resources from non-academic support areas to academic areas to strengthen faculty teaching and research. Non-academic areas seem to have grown at a faster rate and proportion in recent years.
- The facilities for research are terrible. The support for research is terrible. Yet they expect us to perform at an r1 institution level. The pay is terrible, and I need to overload teaching to survive living expenses in the area with inferior quality of research and facility support I cannot progress in my scholarship and promotion. The promotion process gets more stringent every year, yet support is highly lacking. There is a total imbalance between what is expected and what is provided for support.

In combination, the quantitative results and narrative comments presented here shed light on areas in which faculty feel under- or unappreciated and in which they perceived that inadequate resources are affecting their capacity to perform their responsibilities to their satisfaction. A tension between research and teaching expectations was apparent. There appears to be a faculty perception that expectations for research productivity are increasing without sufficient resources being allocated to ensure their success in this area. In addition, at least some faculty feel as if teaching is not prioritized by university leadership.

Summary Table of Rankings and Percentiles

	Peer Ranking (out of 6 institutions)	Cohort Percentile
Theme 1: Culture of Leadership		
Leadership:		
Senior	4	13
Divisional	3	59
Departmental	5	51
Faculty	3	83
Shared Governance:		
Trust	5	19
Shared Sense of Purpose	5	9
Theme 2: Resources and Support		
Resources and Support:		
Facilities and Work Resources	5	44
Personal and Family Policies	5	19
Health and Retirement Benefits	4	30
Nature of Work:		
Research	6	12
Teaching	6	9
Appreciation and Recognition:		
Scholarship	4	33
Teaching	6	10
Service	5	22
College valued by Pres/Provost	5	26
Dept valued by Pres/Provost	4	34
	4	33

Importance of Ongoing Assessment

Persistent examination of job satisfaction is fundamental in cultivating a conducive and efficacious professional environment at FGCU. Systematic and recurrent evaluations allow organizations' dynamic instrumentality to foster a healthy and productive work environment and to provide a mechanism for organizations to gauge employee contentment, to identify areas of improvement, and to implement targeted interventions. Continuous monitoring of job satisfaction not only facilitates the detection of emerging issues but also enables proactive measures to enhance employee engagement and well-being. By understanding employees' evolving needs and concerns, FGCU can tailor strategies to improve job satisfaction, fortifying employee retention, performance, and overall organizational success. The COACHE survey has provided FGCU leadership and faculty with valuable baseline measures. It will be critical to continue with regular data collection to assess improvement against these baselines, as well as to identify strengths and concerns that may emerge in future administrations of the survey. Furthermore, FGCU will be able to incorporate a few questions and modifications that it believes better reflect the reality of the faculty structure (e.g., no tenure) and unique interests of the university.

Next Steps

In Spring 2024, a second faculty committee, the COACHE Strategy-Setting Taskforce (CSST), is poised to concentrate its efforts on formulating objectives and a measurable action plan for the continuous enhancement of job satisfaction and morale. Concurrently, the team will delve into targeted objectives aimed at identifying and recommending goals to address effectively the priority areas delineated in this report. The rationale behind this strategy, endorsed by the COACHE Steering Committee, underscores the belief that the creation of smaller, more specialized teams will engender heightened faculty participation and facilitate a focused and expeditious trajectory for each designated taskforce. This approach is anticipated to yield more substantive and efficacious outcomes in the pursuit of institutional improvement through the COACHE data.

Meet Our Team

FGCU COACHE STEERING COMMITTEE

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Dr. Meg Atha, COE
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FGCU COACHE PRIORITY-SETTING TASKFORCE

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More information about COACHE at FGCU

www.fgcu.edu/COACHE